GATEPOINT

Event Registration, Badging & Digital Signage Solutions

Bussiness plan

JUN, 2026

Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

1. Executive Summary

GATEPOINT Digital Solutions is a technology-driven event services company specializing in **end-to-end event registration systems, attendee management, digital badging, and on-site event technology infrastructure**. The company combines **software development + physical event execution services**, creating a hybrid model that bridges digital transformation and traditional event management in Ethiopia's growing events sector.

Core Value Proposition

GATEPOINT Digital Solutions solves one of the most persistent problems in the Ethiopian and regional events industry: **inefficient, manual, and error-prone event management processes**.

We provide:

- Fully digital event registration systems
- QR-based check-in and attendance tracking
- Professionally designed and printed badges
- Lanyards and access control materials
- Real-time event dashboards and analytics
- Digital signage and live event display systems
- On-site technical execution teams

Strategic Vision

To transition from a service-based event tech provider into a **full event technology ecosystem owner**, including proprietary software, mobile apps, and scalable SaaS tools for event organizers.

Year 1 Focus

- Execute 12 structured events (1 per month)
- Build operational systems and SOPs
- Develop first version of proprietary registration software
- Establish strong portfolio and client credibility

2. Business Opportunity

The event industry in Ethiopia is still heavily dependent on:

- Paper registration sheets
- Manual attendance tracking
- Unstructured guest lists
- Slow badge creation processes
- Limited real-time reporting

Key Problems in the Market

- Long queues during event registration
- Errors in attendee data collection
- Difficulty tracking attendance and engagement
- Lack of branding consistency in badges and materials
- No centralized data system for event organizers
- Poor post-event analytics and reporting

Opportunity Gap

There is a clear gap between:

- Traditional event planners (manual, low-tech)
- High-end international event tech providers (too expensive or inaccessible)

GATEPOINT Digital Solutions positions itself as:

> A **mid-market, scalable, locally-adapted event technology provider**

Market Timing Advantage

- Increased corporate events in Ethiopia
- Growing NGO and development sector conferences
- Expansion of embassies and international programs
- Rising demand for professional brand experiences
- Digital transformation push across institutions

3. Services (Expanded Breakdown)

3.1 Event Registration Systems

- Custom event landing pages
- Online attendee registration forms

- Payment integration (if needed)
- Confirmation email/SMS systems
- Data export for organizers

3.2 QR Code Check-in System

- Unique QR codes per attendee
- Fast check-in scanning system
- Real-time attendance tracking
- Prevention of duplicate entry
- Offline backup scanning capability

3.3 Badge Design & Printing

- Professional event badge design
- Corporate branding integration
- Role-based badge categories (VIP, Speaker, Guest, Staff)
- On-demand printing at event sites
- Anti-duplication security elements

3.4 Lanyards & Access Materials

- Custom branded lanyards
- Badge holders (plastic, eco-friendly options)
- Wristbands for restricted access events
- Security tagging solutions

3.5 Digital Signage & Displays

- LED screens for event halls
- Schedule displays and speaker rotations
- Branding loops for sponsors
- Live announcements and updates
- Directional signage for large venues

3.6 Attendance Tracking & Analytics

- Real-time attendance dashboards
- Session-level participation tracking
- Heat maps of attendee flow (advanced stage)
- Post-event reporting for organizers

3.7 On-Site Technical Support

- Event setup team deployment
- Hardware installation (scanners, printers, screens)
- Live technical troubleshooting
- Event day coordination support

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4. Target Market

GATEPOINT Digital Solutions targets organizations that frequently host structured events and require professional execution.

Primary Segments

1. NGOs & Development Organizations

- Conferences
- Training programs
- Workshops
- Donor events

2. Corporate Organizations

- Product launches
- Annual meetings
- Brand activations
- Internal conferences

3. Government Institutions

- Policy conferences
- Public sector events
- National forums

4. Embassies & International Bodies

- Diplomatic events
- Cultural programs
- Trade and investment forums

5. Universities & Educational Institutions

- Graduation ceremonies
- Academic conferences

- Student programs

6. Event Agencies

- Subcontracted technical execution partner
- White-label service provider

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5. Business Model

GATEPOINT Digital Solutions operates on a **hybrid service + technology ownership model**.

Revenue Streams

1. Event Service Contracts

- Full event tech execution packages
- Fixed pricing per event

2. Registration Plate-forme Fees

- Per-event software usage fee
- Setup and customization charges

3. Badge Production

- Per badge pricing model
- Bulk production margins

4. Equipment Rental Services

- QR scanners
- Tablets
- Printers
- Digital screens

5. Digital Signage Services

- Daily rental or event-based pricing

6. Future SaaS Model (Long-Term)

- Subscription-based event management platform
- Monthly/annual organizer access

Strategic Advantage

Owning software ensures:

- Data control
- Brand independence
- Scalability
- Recurring revenue potential

6. Operations Plan

Year 1 Operational Strategy

- Minimum: 1 major event per month (12 total)
- Focus on execution quality over volume
- Build repeatable processes

Event Workflow

1. Client onboarding
2. Event requirement analysis
3. System setup (registration + branding)
4. Badge design & production
5. On-site setup
6. Event execution
7. Post-event reporting

Equipment Strategy

- Mix of owned and rented equipment
- Reduce capital pressure in early stage
- Scale ownership as revenue grows

Quality Control

- Pre-event testing of all systems
- Backup equipment for critical tools
- Standard operating procedures (SOPs)

7. Technology Development

GATEPOINT Digital Solutions will develop its **own proprietary event management platform**.

Core Features

- Event creation dashboard
- Registration form builder
- QR code generator
- Attendee database system
- Check-in scanning app
- Analytics dashboard

Phase Development Plan

Phase 1 (month1)

- Basic registration system
- QR check-in system
- Manual reporting tools

Phase 2 (month2)

- Automated analytics
- Payment integration
- Mobile-friendly attendee experience

Phase 3 (Year 3)

- Full SaaS platform
- Multi-event organizer system
- White-label solutions

Strategic Benefit

- Reduces dependency on third-party tools
- Creates intellectual property
- Enables scalability beyond Ethiopia
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8. Marketing Strategy

Core Strategy: Relationship-Based Growth

1. Direct Sales

- Corporate visits
- Event organizer pitching
- Institutional presentations

2. Networking

- Industry events
- NGO forums
- Embassy and diplomatic gatherings

3. LinkedIn Outreach

- Target decision-makers
- Event managers, HR heads, procurement officers

4. Partnerships

- Event planners
- PR agencies
- Venue providers

5. Portfolio Marketing

- Showcase past events visually
- Before/after transformation results
- Case studies

6. Referral System

- Incentivize repeat clients
- Partner-based recommendations

9. Staffing Plan

Core Team

Managing Director

- Strategy
- Client acquisition

- Financial oversight

Operations Coordinator

- Event execution planning
- Logistics coordination
- Client communication

Software Developer

- Platform development
- Maintenance and updates
- System integration

Event Support Team

- On-site setup
- Equipment handling
- Technical assistance

Freelance Staff

- Badge printing assistants
- Registration staff
- Event day helpers

10. Startup Requirements

Technology & Equipment

- Laptops (development + operations)
- QR scanners (multiple units)
- Badge printers
- Tablets for check-in stations
- Portable Wi-Fi routers
- Power backup systems

Production Materials

- Badge paper stock
- Lanyards
- Plastic badge holders
- Ink and printing supplies

Digital Infrastructure

- Cloud hosting for system
- Domain + website
- Software development tools

Marketing Assets

- Company profile
- Portfolio presentations
- Demo system

11. Financial Projections

Year 1 Projection

- Number of events: 12
- Average revenue per event: ETB 200,000

Total Revenue

ETB **2,400,000**

Cost Structure (Estimated)

- Equipment rental/purchase
- Staff payments per event
- Software development costs
- Transportation and logistics
- Marketing and client acquisition

Profit Outlook

- Moderate profit in Year 1 (due to setup costs)
- Higher margins expected from Year 2 onward

Growth Assumption

- Event size increases
- Premium pricing for corporate clients
- Recurring contracts

12. Risk Analysis

1. Competition Risk

- New entrants in event tech space
  Mitigation: Build strong brand + proprietary software advantage

2. Technology Failure

- System crashes during live events
  Mitigation: Offline backup systems + manual fallback procedures

3. Equipment Downtime

Mitigation: Redundant equipment and rental partnerships

4. Client Acquisition Risk

Mitigation: Aggressive networking and partnerships early on

5. Cash Flow Pressure

Mitigation: Advance payments + phased event billing

13. Growth Plan

Short-Term (Year 1–2)

- Establish strong portfolio
- Build reputation in corporate and NGO sectors
- Refine internal systems

Mid-Term (Year 2–3)

- Launch full SaaS event platform
- Expand to regional markets
- Introduce mobile event apps

Long-Term (Year 3–5)

- Become leading East African event tech company
- Offer white-label platforms for agencies
- Expand into hybrid and virtual events

14. Mission Statement

To become Ethiopia's leading provider of **event registration, attendee management, badging, and digital event infrastructure solutions**, transforming how organizations execute and experience events through technology-driven innovation.